Samosa dough

A crisp, flaky samosa shell from plain flour and gram flour, three to one

Makes about 12 samosas · **Prep** 20 min · **Cook** 12 min per batch · **Rest** 30 min

> *Draft quantities for David to check. The note gives cups, so the grams here are converted from them. The yield and the oil temperature are worked out, not tested.*

Gram flour adds a golden colour, a nutty smell and extra crunch to the usual flaky shell. Keep it to a quarter of the flour, make the dough very stiff, and fry slowly so the gram flour cooks through.

INGREDIENTS

For the dough

- 190 g (1½ cups) plain flour (maida)
- 45 g (½ cup) gram flour (besan)
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp carom seeds (ajwain)
- 4 tbsp ghee or oil, warm
- About 120 ml (½ cup) ice-cold water, added gradually

To finish

- Potato and pea filling, cooked and cooled
- Neutral oil, for deep-frying

METHOD

1. **Mix the dry ingredients.** Whisk the plain flour, gram flour, salt and ajwain together in a large bowl.
2. **Rub in the fat (moyen).** Pour in the warm ghee or oil and rub it into the flour with your fingertips for 2–3 minutes, until it looks like fine breadcrumbs. Squeeze a handful in your fist: if it holds its shape without crumbling, there is enough fat for a flaky crust.
3. **Knead a stiff dough.** Add the ice-cold water a tablespoon at a time and knead into a very stiff, firm dough. A soft or wet dough gives samosas air bubbles and makes them oily.
4. **Rest.** Cover with a damp cloth and leave for 20–30 minutes.
5. **Roll and cut.** Divide the dough into 6 equal balls, roll each into a smooth oval about 15 cm (6 in) long, and cut it across the middle into two semicircles.
6. **Shape and fill.** Fold each semicircle into a cone, sealing the seam with a dab of water. Fill it, then seal the open edge tightly with a little more water.
7. **Fry low and slow.** Slide the samosas into moderately hot oil, about 150–160 °C, and fry on low to medium heat for 10–12 minutes, turning, until crisp and deep golden.

NOTES

- Too much gram flour makes the dough heavy and brittle; the 3:1 ratio of plain to gram flour keeps it elastic enough to roll thin.

- The 3:1 ratio is by volume. By weight, gram flour is lighter, so it comes to about 190 g to 45 g.
- Fried hot, the outside browns before the gram flour cooks through, so keep the heat low.